



CYCLICK SAMPLES

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80s Synths Part Two

This second part of the collection focusses on the non-bass (I'm a bass player so that's the dividing line on instrumentation): leads, arps, pads and polys. As with Part One the looped lines and multisamples start from modelled classic 80s synths (see below), which are programmed and tweaked into shape (sometimes between lines) and then run through an almost pure 1908s signal path.

The synths are routed in Nuendo to an external effects plugin slot (i.e. latency delay compensated stereo send/return link as a plugin) which is followed by the UAD ATR-102 tape emulation for some tape tone (slight HF enhancement and saturation) and Ozone 8 Vintage Limiter to prevent overshoots. The external send/return starts and ends with the Orion 32 A/D and D/A converters and runs through a stereo channel of the Amek BCII mixer (the BC1119/4 module) making use of the excellent three band EQ. This EQ has high and low shelves (80/160Hz and 6/10kHz) and a remarkably powerful fixed Q swept mid parametric band (250Hz to 7kHz). Within Nuendo the synths are also sent to a pair of effects routes which also employ external effects plugins. One is a stereo line to a Yamaha SPX1000 (1988) which is preceded by a non-80s EQ, the JDK Audio R24 (4 band parametric), to pre-shape the parallel effect. The SPX1000 delivered reverbs (hall, early reflection, reverse and gated) and modulations (chorus and flange), which it does very well, which is why it lives on in my outboard racks. The other effects channel is mono and pairs a Klark-Teknik DN27 graphic equaliser with a Boss DE200 digital delay. The former is an inductor based 27-band equaliser which is actually from the 70s but was still going strong in the early 80s until it was superseded by a non-inductor version which was 'cleaner' and much cheaper to produce, though without the juice of the all important inductors and I/O transformers (Sowter no less). The Boss DE-200 is just magic. Mostly it is run in 'x2' which doubles the delay time by halving the sample rate, i.e. sacrifices a bunch of high end and ends up sounding cooler as a result. This is set loosely to the tempo, as being precise is just too rigid and a little modulation dialled in to add extra movement. These effects channels were routed in the main synth output group so they were squeezed in along side the synth signal in its journey through the BCII and beyond.

The multisamples run from C1 to C5 and, where necessary, have their sustain loop points embedded into the WAV file for easy transportation into samplers. A set of SFZ files are also included to save any manually key mapping. All multisamples are run with four even spaced notes per octave (C, D#, F# and A).

Outboard

Amek BCII mixer (BC1119/4 stereo channel)
Yamaha SPX1000 multi-effect processor
Boss DE-200 digital delay
Klark-Teknik DN27 graphic equaliser (pre DE-200)
JDK Audio R24 dual 4-band EQ (pre SPX1000)

Synths (from Arturia V Collection):

CZ V
DX7 V
CMI V
Jup-8 V3
Matrix-12 V2
Prophet V3
Synclavier V

Plugins:

Eventide Instant Flanger MkII (on one instrument)
Arturia MiniFilter (also just the once)
UAD Ampex ATR-102 (post BCII)
Ozone 8 Vintage Limiter (post ATR-102 to prevent overshoots)